School Closure Report

Irvington Elementary School

Date: 11/17/2026

School Closure Process
The PPS Board of Education determines whether schools will be closed. Board determination on school closures is based on the Superintendent's recommendation. The School Initiation & Closure policy (6.10.030-P) requires that the Superintendent's recommendation be accompanied by a School Closure Report.

If you have questions about this process or this report, please contact:

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501 N Dixon, Portland, OR 97227 | 503-916-2000

1. School Profile

School Name
Irvington Elementary School

Administrator
Gary Gregoricka

Location
1320 NE Brazee St, Portland OR

Grade levels served
K-5

1a. School Description

Irvington Elementary School is a K–5 neighborhood school, centered in the Irvington neighborhood of Northeast Portland. Built in 1932, the two-story school has 30 classrooms and has approximately 260 students enrolled in 2026-2027.

1b. Financial Impact

The primary financial benefit of consolidating elementary schools and programs is to align school capacity and operating costs with enrollment, allowing PPS to concentrate limited resources in fewer, more efficiently resourced schools. Combining school communities can reduce duplicative school-level administrative and operating expenses, improve building utilization, and support more efficient staffing and program delivery. These consolidations are intended to generate ongoing savings while supporting strong core instructional programs and student services.

If the school remains open, the projected cost per student for the 2027/2028 school year is: $17,363.

If the school is closed in 2027, the projected overall savings is $899,830. This includes savings from administrative, custodial, and office staffing, 80% of utilities, and includes the one-time cost of teacher moves. We anticipate ongoing expenses, including 20% of current utility costs and an average annual security cost, if the school were closed and unoccupied.

Under the proposed change, 30% of students would live more than one mile from Beverly Cleary and would be offered school bus transportation. To accommodate these students, PPS anticipates increasing service to Beverly Cleary from zero to two buses. The Transportation Department estimates an additional annual cost of $50,000.

Transportation and Safe Routes to School planning will identify needed supports for safe arrival and dismissal, including walking and biking improvements, crossing supports, or traffic circulation changes. Transportation arrangements and costs for the temporary swing site will be assessed separately and communicated to families before the transition.

1c. Student Enrollment

Table 1. Projected enrollment over the next five years, if school remains open:

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Students Enrolled	240	236	229	220	223

History of Requested and Actual Transfers

During 2024-25, 2025-26, and 2026-27 school years, 44 students requested transfers into Irvington, and 17 enrolled through an approved transfer. During the same period, 95 students residing within the school's attendance area requested transfers to other schools, and 31 enrolled elsewhere through an approved transfer.

Projected declining enrollment will make it difficult to maintain stable staffing, full programming, and essential student support services. Under enrollment-based staffing allocations, low enrollment can result in year-to-year staffing changes, blended-grade classrooms or combined programs, and reduced access to enrichment and student support offerings. Staff may serve multiple roles or split time across schools, limiting continuity and availability. While educators would continue working to meet students' needs, projected enrollment would constrain the school's ability to provide consistent access to a well-rounded educational experience without ongoing supplemental district resources.

2. School Facilities and Student Reassignment

2a. School Description

Built	**Building size**	**Stories**	**Acres**
1932	59,874 SF	2	3.45
Building condition	**Gross capacity**	**Functional capacity**	**Cost of school operations**
Poor; FCI 0.28	780 students	618 students	$4,097,714

Gross capacity is the estimated maximum number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by assigning a student capacity to each classroom based on its square footage and summing those capacities:

- Less than 800 square feet: 24 students
- 800–1,000 square feet: 27 students
- More than 1,000 square feet: 30 students

Functional capacity is a practical estimate of the number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by multiplying its gross capacity by the applicable utilization rate. It does not represent maximum occupancy under building code requirements or determine staffing levels.

The cost of school operations includes projected FY28 school-based costs in funds 100 and 200 plus Facilities, Nutrition Services, and Special Education, at the current service level.

Physical Condition of Building, Capital and Environmental Needs
Irvington is a two-story reinforced-concrete school faced in sand-colored brick, with a red tile roof and terra cotta detailing. Facility assessments identified aging HVAC equipment; corrosion and leakage in boiler-support equipment; an older water heater beyond its typical design life;

and electrical distribution and lighting systems beyond their typical design lives. The roof was significantly cracked, skylights were beyond design life, and leaks were identified in the boiler room and storage area. There was a recent fire-alarm replacement but no fire-suppression system.

ADA Accessibility
The main entrance and first floor are accessible; however, there is no accessible route to the second-floor classrooms.

Building Use
Currently, Irvington houses a K–5 neighborhood school with general education classrooms, enrichment instruction, and student support services.

Analysis of current and potential use of the facility, including recommended disposition
Following closure, potential uses of the Irvington facility will be evaluated through the district's Building Repurposing process, informed by community engagement, district needs, facility conditions, and financial considerations. This process will consider opportunities to support students and the surrounding community and identify a recommended future use or disposition for Board consideration. If in-process feasibility assessments confirm, Irvington would likely be used as a temporary swing-site during the 2027-2028 Beverly Cleary seismic work.

2b. Student Reassignment

The proposed closure of Irvington would reassign neighborhood K–5 students to Beverly Cleary. The attendance area's grades 6–8 pathway would shift from Harriet Tubman to Beaumont Middle School. Special Education students receiving Learning Center support would continue to receive support at Beverly Cleary K–5.

Proposed Attendance Boundary
See attached map.

Transportation options and barriers
Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for elementary students who live more than one mile from their neighborhood school; additional students may qualify based on Oregon Department of Education guidelines or individual needs. We do not anticipate any barriers to students getting to school; however, additional busing may be provided, as needed, for hazard areas within the school attendance boundary.

How will this school location accommodate the reassigned students?
Beverly Cleary has 26 classrooms and a functional capacity of 531 students. After the consolidation with Irvington, Beverly Cleary is projected to hold 502 students in the 2027-2028 school year.

Recommendation
PPS recommends closing Irvington as a neighborhood K–5 school for the 2027–2028 school year and assigning neighborhood K–5 students to Beverly Cleary. The attendance area's middle school pathway would change from Harriet Tubman to Beaumont.

3. Community/Cluster and District Impact Analysis

3a. Cluster Analysis

How will the proposed closure maintain or improve equity of access to schools offering high quality educational choices?
In the 2026-2027 school year, PPS staffs and supports 56 elementary programs. Eleven of these programs are situated within K-8 campuses. Enrollment ranges from 160 students to over 550 students. Using the QEM and our system definition of "well-resourced schools" as a guide, we have established an elementary enrollment of 360 as the minimum threshold to be able to staff and support a comprehensive and stable elementary program. Maximizing the number of sites at or above this minimum threshold allows the district to maximize the number of students who experience grade-level classrooms, comprehensive core enrichments, and targeted academic supports. It also maximizes the number of educators who work full-time on one campus and who benefit from regular collaboration with grade- and content-alike colleagues.

By operating fewer elementary schools and spreading current enrollment more evenly across remaining sites, the district can stabilize and offer a more comprehensive and sustainable program at each elementary site.

In recent years, we have used resources from other parts of our system to subsidize elementary programs with low enrollment. Given our current and projected budget shortfalls, we can no longer sustain subsidies for underenrolled sites. As a result, elementary schools have already faced several programmatic and operational constraints:

- Over half of our elementary programs have been forced to place students in multi-grade classrooms;
- Staffing for instructional coaching, academic coaching, and school climate support positions have been reduced;
- Core enrichment teachers that support Arts, PE, and Library/Media instruction have been split across multiple sites, reducing the capacity to have full-school enrichment programs;
- Support staff that help monitor lunch and recess have been reduced, forcing principals to spend much of their time monitoring duty;
- Opportunities for strong teacher collaboration and professional learning have been compromised by multi-grade classrooms and single-strand programs.

If we continue with no rightsizing action, all of these constraints will be compounded in school year 27-28.

3b. Effects on Other Schools, Enrollment, and Community Access

The proposed merger would affect Beverly Cleary within the Grant cluster. Enrollment at Beverly Cleary is projected to change from 480 (as a K-8) to 502 (as a K-5) in the 2027–2028 school year. Based on current enrollment projections, there will be three to four classrooms at each grade-level, with blends not required. These changes would support a combined elementary school community, with opportunities to stabilize staffing and sustain educational programs

and student supports. Implementation would require coordinated staffing, classroom assignments, and use of shared spaces to accommodate incoming students while supporting students already enrolled. In 2027, students from Irvington would join Beverly Cleary's K–5 students at a temporary swing site while Beverly Cleary undergoes a full seismic retrofit. During the renovation, Beverly Cleary's kitchen will receive minor upgrades, including double ovens and a warming cabinet, to support meal service for the combined school community. Beverly Cleary has sufficient classroom and instructional support space to accommodate the additional students following the renovation.

Irvington is located approximately 1.5 miles from Beverly Cleary's campus. Nearby schools and community resources include Grant High School, Grant Park, and Hollywood Library. The proposed change would shift students' daily school activities toward Beverly Cleary and Grant Park. Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for eligible students. PPS would support school bus service for students who live more than one mile from the school and work with the school community and the district Safe Routes to School coordinator to identify appropriate crossing, pedestrian, and bicycle safety measures.

3c. Community Partnerships and Potential Community Impact

Irvington currently partners with Grow Portland, which teaches a gardening class during the school day. Closure could affect student access to this programming. Irvington students are projected to transition to Beverly Cleary, which does not currently offer Grow Portland. Opportunities for the partnership to continue, relocate, or adapt include bringing the program to Beverly Cleary. Additional community impacts include a possible gap in gardening instruction for transitioning students, with proposed responses including working with Beverly Cleary's building leaders and school community to determine what students need and whether the school is ready to support this partnership.

Irvington Extended Day Child Care is an independent, single-site provider serving approximately 80 students and families through essential after-school care. Closing Irvington without relocating the program to Beverly Cleary could force the business to close, eliminate staff jobs, and disrupt care for the families who depend on it. Although Beverly Cleary currently hosts a YMCA child care program serving approximately 55 students, Irvington Extended Day should be included in space-planning discussions to identify sufficient, appropriately licensed space for both programs to continue operating. This is especially important because five Irvington Extended Day families receive ERDC assistance and could experience funding delays or interruptions if required to change providers. Preserving this partnership would protect an established community resource, maintain employment, and provide approximately 80 students with familiar caregivers and consistent routines during a significant school transition. We ask that Irvington Extended Day be included in early transition planning and provide a viable opportunity to continue serving its families at Beverly Cleary.

Any future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

3d. Operational Plan & Boundary Map

If approved, the closure would take effect in 2027, with students assigned to Beverly Cleary under the proposed boundaries shown in the attached boundary map.

Operational Implementation Plan

Timeline*	Action
January 2027	Establish school transition teams and school-specific implementation plans. Verify student enrollment. Share Principal assignments with communities.
February 2027	Develop staffing plans and confirm initial staff assignments. Identify and prioritize building improvements, equipment, and technology needs.
March 2027	Identify initial classroom assignments and develop school-specific moving schedules, distribute packing supplies, and begin records transfers.
April 2027	Begin packing and sorting materials not needed for daily instruction. Finalize plans for building improvements and technology setup.
May 2027	Confirm summer moving and building-work schedules. Continue packing and prepare materials for transportation and other operational services for receiving schools.
June 2027	Complete teacher packing. Begin school moves after the school year ends and carry out scheduled building improvements.
July 2027	Continue school moves and building improvements. Install furniture, equipment, and technology at receiving schools.
August 2027	Complete scheduled moves by mid August. Finish cleaning, classroom setup, and technology testing.
September 2027	Monitor school operations and address remaining transition needs. Complete closing-building inventories.

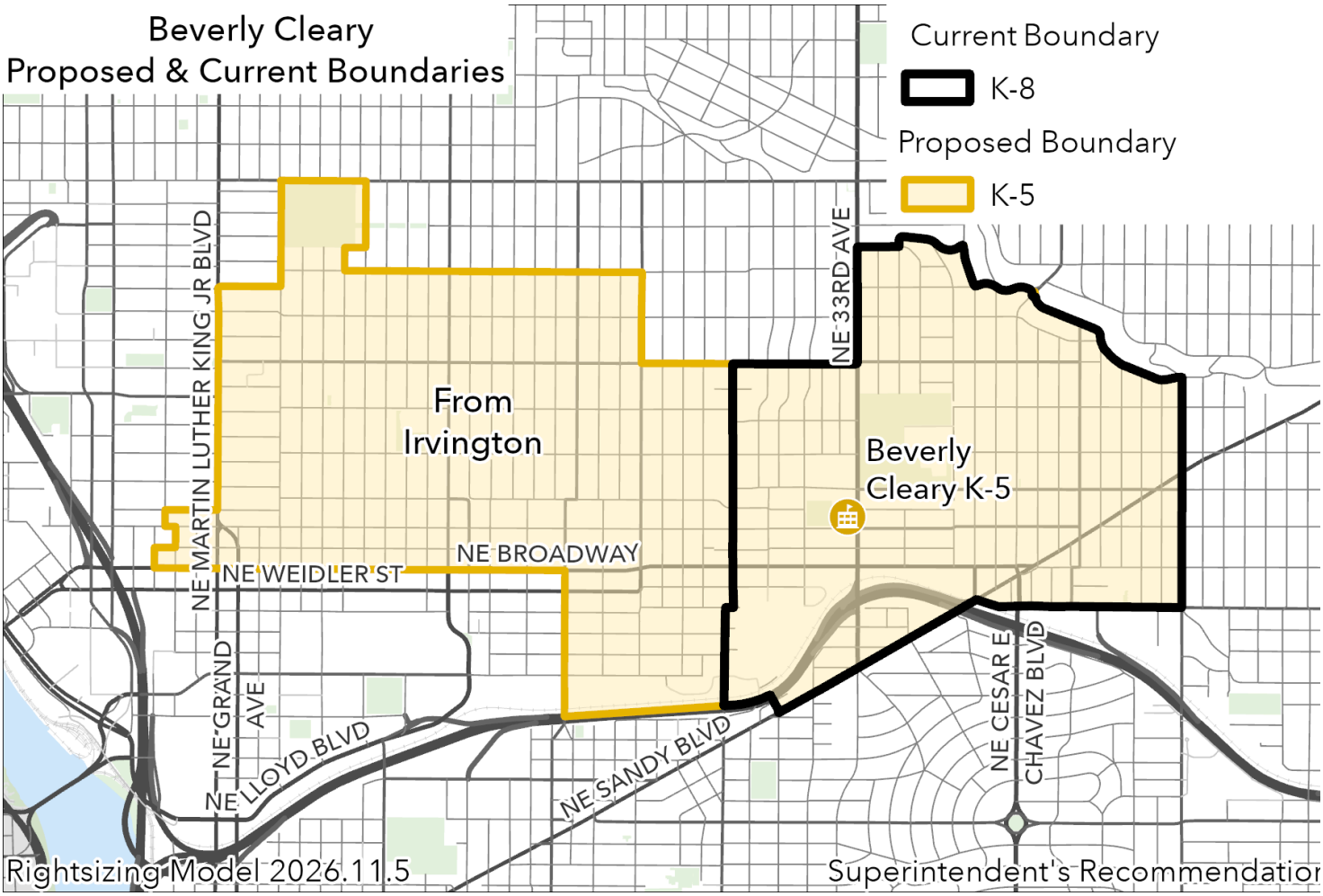
**Subject to change*

Review and Approval

This report has been reviewed by appropriate district staff.

Superintendent Signature

Date


Beverly Cleary
Proposed & Current Boundaries
Current Boundary
K-8
Proposed Boundary
K-5
From
Irvington
Beverly
Cleary K-5
NE MARTIN LUTHER KING JR BLVD
NE 33RD AVE
NE WEIDLER ST
NE BROADWAY
NE GRAND AVE
NE LLOYD BLVD
NE SANDY BLVD
NE CESAR E CHAVEZ BLVD
Rightsizing Model 2026.11.5
Superintendent's Recommendation